

munication channels led the US government to seek alternatives. Baran's suggestion was to use a distributed network, one without any central monitoring and managing function. Packet switching involves breaking down the data to be transferred into small "packets" that contain additional information about its source and destination, in its "header." Each node on the distributed network is intelligent enough to read the header of the packet and either accept it or send it on its way. This way, the packets would ultimately be received by the destination even if part of the network was damaged. The original data is rebuilt at the destination. Packet Switching was only tested in 1969 during the creation of the ARPANET, and was found to be the most effective and efficient way to transfer data on the network. The concept also forms the basis of today's communication on the Internet.

1963

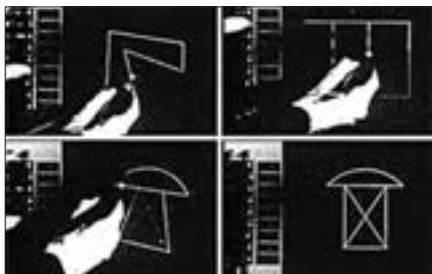
Sketchpad, ASCII

January: The IEEE

The IEEE was founded by merging the AIEE (American Institute of Electrical Engineers) and the IRE (Institute of Radio Engineers). The need for the merger arose since it was felt that the two organisations were increasingly performing overlapping functions, resulting in duplication and competition.

January: Finally, The GUI

Ivan Sutherland created Sketchpad, a software that allows creation of designs merely by drawing them on the screen. Considered the first Graphical User Interface, Sketchpad involved the use of a light pen on the CRT



Sketchpad—you rarely see things like it even today